How to use this sheet

Packing List Builder · travel readier than last time, without the spreadsheet.

Fill the top strip first

Your trip type, days and weather are better packers than any list. A beach week and a mountain cabin need different boxes checked — the details row down decides that for you.

Pack by category, not by room

Clothes, toiletries, tech, everyday — walk around the house once per category rather than once per room. It's slower-feeling, faster-actually, and you end the session done.

Copies of things beat luck

Prescription meds go in the carry-on in original bottles. Chargers stay behind more than phones. One spare packed where you can reach it means a bad day is only an inconvenience.

Make it yours

Strike any item that never applies to your trips and write your own rows on the blank seams. Printing this every trip is one glance, not a micro-project. Need more blank lines? Copy this page as many times as you need.

Packing List Builder

Start with the trip, not with the suitcase. Fill in the details first, then pack by need.

TRIP TYPE	DESTINATION	DAYS AWAY	WEATHER	HOME CHECK DONE
_____	_____	_____	_____	☐

Clothes & wearables

✓	ITEM	NOTES
☐	Shirts / t-shirts	1 per day + 1 spare is the classic rule
☐	Underwear / socks	One spare in the carry-on
☐	Pants / shorts / skirts	Laundry halves this list
☐	Layers / jacket / rain shell	
☐	Sleepwear	Pajamas fit in any small pocket
☐	Comfortable walking shoes	Wear the heaviest pair on travel day
☐	Swimsuit / beach wear	Sun and warm destinations only
☐	Hat / sunglasses	
☐	_____	

Toiletries & health

✓	ITEM	NOTES
☐	Toothbrush, toothpaste, floss	Any store restocks this list
☐	Medications (prescription)	Original bottles plus a printed list — see the Medications & Contacts Card
☐	Pain reliever / basic meds	
☐	Sunscreen / insect repellent	Solid sticks skip the liquid limits
☐	Glasses / contacts + spares	Sunglasses count twice
☐	Small first-aid bits (bandages)	
☐	_____	

Tech & everyday

✓	ITEM	NOTES
☐	Phone + charger	Chargers stay behind most often
☐	Power bank	
☐	Plug adapters (international)	
☐	Headphones	
☐	Keys / wallet / transit cards	Physical pocket check before leaving home
☐	Snacks & refillable bottle	Empty bottles pass airport security

☐	_____	

Trip-type quick lists

Camping: headlamp, bug spray, warm layer, rain gear, sleeping comfort, fire start permission check.
Beach: swimwear ×2, sand towel, sun hat, aloe, dry bag for the phone.
Business: outfit per day, one spare, simple shoes, notepad, quiet-earbuds.
Family trip: one kid-boredom bundle per child — see the Kids Travel-Busy Pages.

The three-bag sanity rule

Pack by bag, not by room: **Carry-on** holds documents, meds, one spare outfit, charger. **Checked bag** holds the duplicates. **Day bag** holds water, snack, sun protection. If a category is missing from all three, that's the thing to fix.